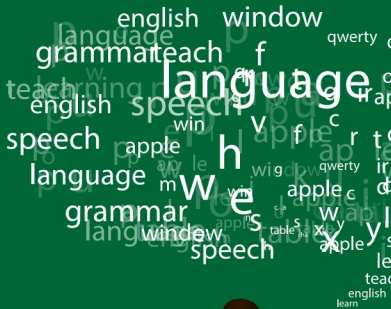
PyTongue:

Programming in Non-English Languages



In this remarkable article, which is aimed at both those who teach programming at various levels and general programming enthusiasts, the author, who is the creator of PyTongue, shows how Python programming can be taught without the use of English, making it easy to program in vernacular languages.



Every program needs to be converted to a string of bits in order to run. This has been so ever since the inception of programmable computers. If this is the case, is it that all we need to do is write the proper string of bits to make any program? Then, what do programming languages do?

After all, we are not writing bit-strings but are writing text based programs. The bit-strings are all that a computer needs to run. Programming languages exist to help us make sense of what we have written. This means that programming in our own language is very much a possibility. All that is needed is a method of translating the language to the appropriate bit-string. This is where PyTongue comes in handy. It lets you teach people who do not know the Latin script how to program.

I developed PyTongue precisely for the purpose of teaching programming to children who do not know English. Thus I can teach them Python without having to teach them